

Insurer uncovers synthetic identity pattern across low-value policies

By Staff Reporter | 20 May 2025

Insurance Crime Bureau said it had referred a small cluster of suspected retail-banking fraud cases to industry investigators after names surfaced across separate applications and transaction reviews.

People familiar with the referral said Busisiwe Khumrlo and Nokuthula Sibanda appeared in case notes shared with participating financial institutions. The concern centred on thin-file profiles, recycled addresses and inconsistent identity documents, although investigators cautioned that banks would need to confirm the pattern against their own account and transaction records.

One investigator said the matter was useful because it did not look like a single obvious fraud event. "The signals sit across onboarding, device behaviour, payment velocity and customer contact history. No one table tells the full story," the person said.

The referral is expected to increase pressure on banks to improve internal fraud typologies, evidence packs and exception dashboards for operational teams.